



CUSTOMER SERVICE

Customer service and experience are key areas where your business can compete. While some customers and clients will be impressed by a flashy website or stylish premises, all appreciate feeling valued and cared for, which requires time and thought—not money.

Regularly review how you interact with your customers and clients, and how well. Think about every aspect of your business, and the products or services you offer, from your customers' perspectives. What would they think? How would they rate you? Are you better than your rivals? Then think about your customers and what matters to them. Why do they buy from you? What do they come back? Pay attention to the smaller details, as it is often the little things that people notice and appreciate – and remember.

You can also target your marketing more effectively by offering tailored promotions, and communicate with your customers or clients as valued individuals.



NEED TO KNOW

- › **Customer experience management** is the tools and processes a business uses to manage and improve interactions with its customers.
- › **Customer journey** describes the entire purchasing lifecycle, from initial interest, through purchase, to aftercare.
- › **Loyalty programs** encourage return business, offering rewards to clients or customers based on the amount they spend.
- › **"Sticky" customers** are loyal consumers who return to your business to make more purchases.

"It takes months to find a customer... seconds to lose one."

Vince Lombardi, American football coach

Support and service

Engage with your customers as individuals and give excellent, personalized service. Offer guarantees and good aftercare service to inspire confidence.

Loyalty programs

Offer customers emotional benefits, such as rewards for making purchases, and discounts for their friends and family. Add them to your mailing list and communicate regularly.



Regular customer

The customer knows they can rely on your products and services, and trusts you enough to make regular purchases.

Valued customer

The customer begins to feel valued and makes regular purchases in preference to other businesses.

Advocate

The customer makes regular purchases, feels loyal to your business, and actively recommends it to others.